

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with a year of legal placement experience at BCLP (International Arbitration and Real Estate Disputes) and current legal advisory work at Citizens Advice. Experienced in preparing hearing bundles, managing case files, drafting procedural documents, reviewing evidence and communicating with clients on sensitive matters. Comfortable handling competing deadlines across multiple matters and supporting fee earners directly on substantive litigation work.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedures, evidence analysis and legal research
- Dissertation: data protection and GDPR development across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from client instruction through to submission: takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies, identifies legal and evidential issues across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and maintains confidential case records to deadline
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex legal points
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options, translating complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended sections of the memorial and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated outstanding documents, tracked actions and liaised with the client and an external translator to ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and other court materials

- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several concurrent matters with competing deadlines using iManage
- Assisted with court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Prepared client notes and maintained matter records

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, including children's personal data and adtech, and identified compliance risks with recommended mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements, identifying contractual risks and assessing alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis and evidence review; electronic bundling; iManage; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems; concise report and correspondence drafting

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation across multiple concurrent matters, deadline tracking, confidential document management